



CAL POLY
Mechanical Engineering
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

Cal Poly ME Graduate Program 2026 Update



<https://ericwadelab.github.io/pages/GradInfo.2026.UG.pdf>

- ➊ Why YOU should get a graduate degree in ME
- ➋ Admissions process and timeline
- ➌ Degree requirements
- ➍ Your questions

A graduate degree in ME

Advantages

- Specialization: R&D, academia, innovation
- Additional skillset
- Salary (\$7-\$10K initial)

Disadvantages

- Finances (temporary)
- Time

Application process and timeline

BMS application

- **Deadline: Nov. 16, 2026**
- Required documents:
 - Personal statement
 - Transcripts (automatic)
 - List of three referees

Review process

- GPA (>3.0)
- Ability to succeed in our program (transcript, statement, letters)

Transitioning to graduate status – plan ahead!

Fall '26

 ME department application
 Blended program application form

Spring '26

 PBCO form by Week 5

Fall '27

Grad standing



MS in ME degree requirements

Description	# Courses
ME Core classes	2
ME technical electives	2
Culminating experience	2
Math requirement	1
Technical electives (CENG)	3
Total:	10

<https://catalog.calpoly.edu/engineering/mechanical/mechanical-engineering-ms/>

Some considerations (thesis option)

Finding an advisor

- Grad seminar
- Your instructors
- Faculty webpages
- Ask me

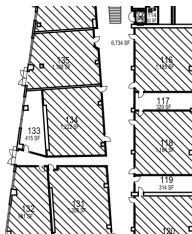
Some considerations (course option)

Culminating experience

- Select three courses (5000-level)
- Exams to be completed within 1 week
- Exams graded by instructors; must pass 66%

Facilities and resources

- Graduate Student Lab (192-133) (work space, meetings)



- Kennedy Library (printing, etc.)
- Room reservations (Building 13) me-dept@calpoly.edu

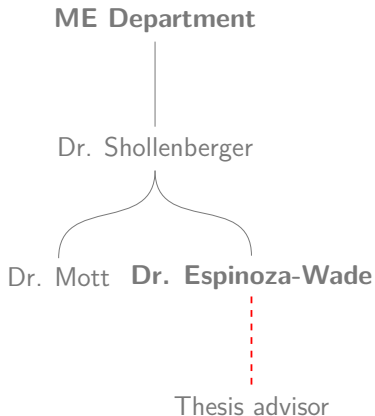
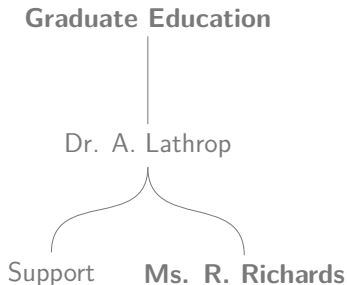
Funding opportunities

- Grading (\$18/hr), lab sections
- Tuition waivers (research assistants, employees, etc., Due June)
- Fellowships (\$5K, \$15K)
- Other opportunities may become available

<https://grad.calpoly.edu/financial-opportunities/graduate-research-award>

>> Resources >> Financial opportunities

Further questions (?)



Other questions/comments

erwade@calpoly.edu